

Ian Cowpar

PM at principal scope | AI capability + operational platforms | Salesforce Service Cloud operator (UTA upgrade) | Zero-translation systems

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SUMMARY

Senior product manager who lives at the intersection of operational platforms and AI capability — building the systems internal teams depend on and the data products that route the right decision. Owned product on UKG's multi-year UTA enterprise upgrade program — operated daily inside Salesforce Service Cloud (case/SR creation, effort tracking across handoffs, approval-flow routing, full SR lifecycle) — while building the organization's first organized AI capability layer and a 0→1 self-serve platform that removed engineering from the critical path of a ticket-gated enterprise workflow. A decade prior at Broadridge running 40+ enterprise client deployments in compliance-grade financial services. Maintain 20 custom slash commands and a personal Claude Code productivity OS in active daily use. Originator of the Zero-Translation Building framework; weekly published thought leadership on AI adoption realism.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager · UKG · Lowell, MA · Jun 2024 – Apr 2026

\$250M ARR enterprise platform program · UTA upgrade ownership, Salesforce Service Cloud operations, AI capability, 0→1 product

- **Owned product on UKG's multi-year UTA enterprise upgrade program — operating daily inside Salesforce Service Cloud throughout** — protecting 300 enterprise customers and \$250M ARR through migration off legacy workforce management. Created SRs, entered effort across every handoff, routed through approval stages, managed full SR lifecycle in coordination with support — building deep operational fluency with UKG's Salesforce data model and case/SR objects from the inside (operator, not admin).
- **Within that program, built a composite ARR-risk model that surfaced ~\$50M in at-risk ARR requiring immediate intervention** before escalation — by replacing raw ticket counts with weighted signal across exposure, case volume, true-defect rate, and Salesforce sentiment, and automating the weekly metric the program lead acted on.
- **Built the product organization's first organized AI capability layer**, scaling shared infrastructure that 20 PMs adopted with sustained voluntary creation — multiple PMs built their own custom slash commands that replaced manual workflows entirely (behavior extinction, not addition) — by designing for org-wide reuse from day one, running the founding peer group, and coaching individual PMs into role-specific use cases without top-down mandate.
- **Shipped a 0→1 self-serve migration platform from idea to production in a one-week prototype cycle**, projected to deliver ~30% time reduction in the underlying enterprise workflow and remove engineering from the critical path of a previously ticket-gated process — by personally writing the working prototype in Claude Code, decomposing scope across three business epics (UI, rules, deployment), and delivering an engineering-ready package the platform architect built against.
- **Designed an opinionated operational analytics product with a Claude Code function embedded as a first-class feature**, cutting a working defect list from ~200 issues to 5 (~97% reduction) so engineering triaged signal not noise — by classifying open issues across five panels (escalations, defects, internal bugs, CVEs, noise) across four products and surfacing the single highest-leverage action per panel.
- **Influenced cross-functional prioritization across product, engineering, and services without direct authority** in executive escalation rooms — synthesizing what 300 enterprise customers (\$250M ARR) actually needed against what was committed, translating that into tradeoff decisions across four product lines.

Brand Champion, UKG North America Regional Lead 2026 · Fire Up ERG (women and allies), Business Innovation workstream lead

Business Analyst · Broadridge Financial Solutions · Andover, MA · Jan 2014 – Jun 2024

- **Led 40+ enterprise client deployments end-to-end in a compliance-grade financial services environment**, partnering deeply with engineering on system behavior, data flows, integration dependencies, and technical tradeoffs — built strong instincts for regulatory-consequence delivery, requirements quality, and the difference between a delivery that closes and a product that keeps producing.
- **Served as internal subject-matter expert for an omni-channel communication product adopted across the full enterprise client base**, translating complex technical and compliance capabilities into workflows non-technical buyers could operate without support — the same intake/translation pattern this role's value-add is built around.

Sr. Document Development Analyst · Broadridge Financial Solutions · Andover, MA · Jan 2006 – Jan 2014

- Built and maintained complex client-facing document and communication systems in a regulated financial services environment — the governance and requirements-rigor foundation the later deployment-leadership work was built on.

SKILLS AND FOCUS AREAS

Salesforce & Operational Platforms: Salesforce Service Cloud daily-operator fluency (case/SR creation, effort tracking across handoffs, approval-flow routing, full SR lifecycle management); deep familiarity with UKG's Salesforce data model and case/SR objects (operator, not admin/builder); cross-functional partnership with support and platform architecture; pragmatic configuration-vs-customization judgment from the consumer side

Product (Principal scope): Product strategy and 2–3 year roadmap, intake and demand management, structured intake processes (intake forms, triage, backlog grooming), root-problem-vs-stated-solution discipline, prioritization and tradeoff decisions in ambiguous spaces, 0→1 product building, outcomes over output, mentoring junior PMs, recognized SME leadership, influence without authority across product / engineering / GTM, B2B SaaS

AI as Co-Builder: Deep daily use of agentic AI tooling (20 custom slash commands and a personal Claude Code productivity OS in active use); embedding AI features inside internal products; AI capability enablement at org scale; responsible / customer-centric AI judgment; agentic workflows; Zero-Translation Building (framework originator)

Data & Analytics: Opinionated analytics products, composite scoring and risk modeling, success-metric definition, hypothesis-driven development, qualitative-to-structured synthesis, KPI definition

Technical Credibility: APIs and system architecture, data flows and integration tradeoffs, deployment-model thinking, technical-systems fluency with engineering, requirements engineering, SQL

Tooling: Jira, Confluence, GitHub, SQL, Salesforce (Service Cloud — operator), Slack MCP, Claude Code CLI

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Management Information Systems and Management

Manning School of Business, UMass Lowell · 1999

WRITING AND THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

The Unofficial Leader (Substack) · theunofficialleader.substack.com

Weekly publication on where AI actually earns its place, adoption realism, and what's happening beneath the surface of how teams work. Originator of the Zero-Translation Building framework. Active LinkedIn audience engagement on product, AI adoption, and team dynamics.